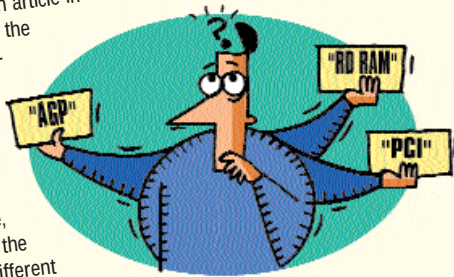


Gimme more

I am a student studying in the second year of a BCA course in Hyderabad. I am quite interested in the hardware and software tests carried out by your Test Centre.

I request that you do an article in your magazine related to the basic components of hardware units, such as motherboards. Perhaps in these you could explain which are the various types (or formats) of motherboards available, explain the functions of the slots, compare the different architectures, etc. This should also be done for other components like RAM.



Perhaps you could also include a bit of history on these components.

ASHLYN D'MELLO

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Ashlyn,

If you consider the October issue of Digit in particular, you would find that we already do a lot of what you have requested for.

If, for instance, you're looking to understand the choices available in motherboards, then just refer to the special Smart Buyer's Guide in the October issue. If you need more detailed information, however, then refer to the comparison tests in the Test Drive section, or some of the Insight articles.

Also keep an eye out for our workshops in the Wired section or the Hands-on video workshops that are included in the Digit Interactive Mindware CDs.

Safety first

Hi

I read your editorial titled 'Trading Freedom for Safety'.

From what I have read on the Net, most people seem to be willing to give up their privacy if it can help them protect from future terrorist attacks or any such danger.

One of them went to the extent of saying that he doesn't mind if someone sits beside him and reads his e-mail as he is checking them.

To be frank, I don't see why privacy is such a big deal. I think that most Indians would accept something similar if it could prevent any terrorist attacks from happening here.

Seems to me like we are just making a big deal out of a small issue.

PRASANTH

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Prasanth,

Most of us are willing to give up certain liberties that are otherwise taken for granted because we feel insecure. While this is especially true in the United States at this point in time, there are many others in that country who consider this a mistake.

This is because while an environment like this might seem acceptable now, eventually it leads to an atmosphere devoid of trust and is not something that people in normal times will reconcile themselves to.

Missed take

Dear Sir,

Over the past few months Digit has been providing us with a staggering amount of information through the comparison tests of MP3 players, digital cameras, graphics cards and more. It is based on all these comparison tests and articles that I plan to upgrade my computer and buy new hardware in the future.

However, one category of products that you seem to have missed out on is the digital camcorder. So far, in all the issues of Digit that I have seen, there haven't been any articles that provide me with information or test results for digital camcorders.

Please consider including this in your forthcoming issues.

ARIEZ RAVI THOMAS

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Ariez,

Guess we did manage to miss something out.

We find that getting buying advice on certain product categories is of more importance to the majority of our readers. These categories usually also feature a larger range of products for us to compare.

At this point in time, since there are several other categories that we feel meet these criteria better, we have not planned for a digital camcorder comparison test.

However, look out for reviews of these products in our stand-alone product review section (Radar).

Of greater value

Hello,

The A-List section in Digit informs us about the best products and their prices. But most of them are pretty expensive. Why don't you also list the products that offer the best value for money?

Buying the most expensive product isn't always the best option for us. I look forward to the latest version of the A-List in every issue, but it is disappointing not to see my favourite 'great value' products listed in there.

So please consider changing the focus of the A-List.

CHINMAY PANDIT
via e-mail

digit

Dear Chinmay,

As you mention, the A-List is about the best performing product that we have tested up to a particular time.

The problem is that the perception of value is something that can differ according to the personal preferences or requirements of an individual. So even though we think that a 100 GB disk drive that costs Rs 14,000 is a great value offering (considering the low cost per megabyte), this might not be true for someone who is quite happy with the 20 GB of disk space that a drive costing Rs 5,000 would give him. Basically, whether a product offers great value depends on the user's specific needs. This is something that can be explained in detail in the course of a comparison test, as we do using the Decision Maker, but is not possible in a product listing.

Performance on the other hand, is something that can be objectively calculated and compared, which is why it will remain the focus of our A-List.